young Jew of Palestine was "as hard, as narrow, as fanatical, and as bitter as the Hitler youth on whom he was modelled" and described Zionism as "a combination of Judaism and Nazism."[6] Other high-ranking officials in the Palestine administration, such as Lord Altrincham, claimed that the Zionist youth movements were a copy of the Hitler youth.[7] Then in the 1950s, the famous British historian and passionate Arab protagonist, Arnold J. Toynbee, put the trope on an intellectual footing.[8] He claimed in *A Study of History* that the Zionists were the disciples of the Nazis because they had "chosen to imitate some of the evil deeds that the Nazis had committed against the Jews."[9] He also claimed a moral equivalence between Israel's attitude to the Arabs in 1947 and 1948 and the Holocaust.[10] Although Toynbee's account of the Jews has received wide condemnation as a historical text, his claim that Zionism is the avatar of Nazism has survived and even thrived in Britain.[11] The trope may even be said to have entered mainstream public opinion as early as the 1950s.[12]

It may not be surprising, then, that Holocaust inversion has recently been used by at least four members of Parliament, two from the Liberal Democrat Party and two from the Labour Party, to publicly execrate Israel.[13] What is most disappointing, however, is the failure of the party leadership to discipline them for engaging in antisemitic discourse. After all, the 2006 *Report of the All-Party Parliamentary Committee of Inquiry into Antisemitism*, which was an attempt to institutionalise a particular approach to the understanding of antisemitism,[14] had recommended that the Government adopt the EUMC Working Definition of Anti-Semitism,[15] which specifically lists the "Nazification" of Israel as a manifestation of contemporary antisemitism. Moreover, the 2009 Report of the European Institute for the Study of Contemporary Antisemitism, *Understanding the Nazi Card: Intervening Against Antisemitic Discourse* (The 2009 EISCA Report), which was funded by the Department of Communities and Local Government to examine the consequences of antisemitic discourse, reported that the "Nazification of Israel" has the potential to incite violence against British Jews and that "the Government and all the main parties are aware of the problem with the Nazi card."[16] Furthermore, the Jewish community in Britain complained to the party leaderships that statements which "Nazify" Israel were antisemitic.

I will focus here on one recent example of Holocaust inversion in the Liberal Democrat Party and the weak response from the party leadership in order to shed some light on why the public practice of Holocaust inversion by politicians is not treated as antisemitism and properly disciplined in Great Britain.

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